

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The paralegal role at Thompsons Solicitors appeals to me because clinical negligence work sits close to the client-facing, evidence-intensive practice I have been building, and Thompsons' reputation for claimant-side work makes it a place where I could develop in a direction I care about.

At BCLP I spent six months supporting a complex investment arbitration and six months on real estate disputes. The arbitration work gave me direct experience of what it takes to manage a case file under real deadline pressure: I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and contributed to drafting sections of the Claimant's memorial, then became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline and coordinated documents and outstanding actions to ensure on-time submission. That required the kind of methodical case management and attention to procedural detail that clinical negligence work demands, where a missed step or miscommunicated deadline can affect a vulnerable client's claim.

Since July 2026 I have been advising clients at Citizens Advice East Berkshire across welfare, housing, family and debt matters. Many of the people I see are in difficult circumstances and need someone who can take an accurate factual account, identify the legal issues quickly, explain what the procedural options are in plain terms, and prepare the necessary documents. I manage each matter from the initial interview through to submission, drafting correspondence, maintaining case records and meeting deadlines throughout. The client communication side of that work has sharpened how I handle sensitive information and how I explain complex processes to people who are often stressed or confused, which maps directly onto client contact in a personal injury or clinical negligence context.

I am drawn to claimant-side clinical negligence work specifically because the cases turn on whether someone has been harmed by a failure in care and whether the evidence supports that. That combination of factual investigation, medical evidence review and client support is where my case management experience and my interest in how legal process protects individuals come together. Thompsons works exclusively for claimants, which is the side of this work I want to be on.

I would welcome the chance to bring my case management background and client-facing experience into this caseload and to develop further within a firm that specialises in this area.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva